



September 2006

Engineering The Future

In your September issue, the information you gave about anti-viruses in the complementary booklet was very useful. Also, the free software you gave was valuable for engineering students. The magazine has proved to be very useful to me.

Sumit Khandelwal

Supermodel Digit?

Are you on a diet? Your mag is getting slimmer and slimmer. I finish it in a week. Please make it healthy. Why don't you give soft copies of the *Fast Track* and spend that money in other things like two DVDs or a dual-layer DVD? Why don't you give pictures on a regular basis on your CD/DVD?

Souparna

Dear Souparna,
We certainly have not reduced the number of pages of editorial content in our issues—we have a constant number fixed, from which the only way to go is up. As far as soft copies of *Fast Track* are concerned, well, we do plan to give out previous issues in PDF format with our December DVD—so make sure you get it!

Nothing can replace the convenience of holding a *Fast Track* issue in print and reading it comfortably on the train or bus, reading it on a window ledge, or even in the loo. And you'd be surprised to know that many of our readers do not even have a

computer, but still pick up a copy of *Digit* to update their tech knowledge!

— Executive Editor

Digitized!

I am totally enticed by your magazine. It has so much to offer to professionals, businessmen, students, and regular people. Even my brother, who is in the 8th standard, and my dad, are fans of yours. It has DIGITIZED my family. I was interested in computers from my childhood. And DIGIT has helped me update my knowledge. It also helped me get my dream PC, thanks to your regular articles (*Bazaar*) regarding the processor-motherboard combos and other hardware configurations.

I have a request. I would like you to publish a *Fast Track* on 3ds Max and Combustion.

Salil Sebastian
Ahmedabad

Dear Salil,
Thanks for your appreciation. Regarding a *Fast Track* on 3D, well, we are indeed planning to work on it—just give us a little more time. It'll be a tough job for us because we need to guide our readers and tutor them in the simplest manner.

— Executive Editor

Digit Made Me Dance!

During ragging at my B. Tech., my seniors asked me about my hobbies, and I said it is reading *Digit*. They immediately threw a volley of questions, and me being a loyal *Digit* reader, I faced all the tech questions like Lara Croft. They got jealous; I ended up doing a pole dance and had to play cricket without a bat and ball—all alone.

The moral is, don't ever tell your seniors that reading *Digit* is your hobby!

Prashant Tewari

Dear Prashant,
That is certainly the funniest anecdote I've ever heard related to our magazine! It's disconcerting to hear that you had to do a pole dance, but you must have enjoyed the jaw-dropping faces of your seniors when they were dumbstruck by your techie answers. Way to go!

— Executive Editor

You're Wrong!

Refer page 58 of your September issue (*Jargon Buster*)—CCD And CMOS. The last line indicates that CMOS is found only on some high-end cameras. In contrast, in your *Fast Track to Digital Photography* in March 2005, on page 26: "CCD or CMOS" indicates that CMOS image quality is poor, is cheaper, and that CCD is recommended. Now my personal experience: all Web cameras are with CMOS; CMOS image quality is poor, and so far, most good-quality digital cameras are CCD-based—CMOS-based digicams do not have optical zoom. Why the anomaly? Do you agree with the experience expressed? Your clarification will help.

G Rajagopal
Chennai

Dear Rajagopal,
CMOS has always been a technology that is very difficult to perfect, which is why some of the top-end CMOS-based digital cameras are very expensive. However low-quality CMOS-based cameras are very cheap—such as the ones typically found on Web cameras. CCD, in contrast, is very easy to integrate, and the quality is far superior (for the price). CCD doesn't scale price-wise like CMOS does: the variance in price with a really low-end CCD and a high-end CCD is fairly small in comparison. Lastly, Web cameras and digital cameras are two different product classes (and never the twain shall meet).

— Executive Editor

Do I Have A Future

I want to know, what is the future of Networking and Certifications such as N+, MCSE 2003, CISCO, etc. in the IT field? What qualification is required with such certifications? Please e-mail me an answer, or include this letter (and a reply) in your magazine.

Sharath S
Tumkur District, Karnataka

Dear Sharath,
First of all, I'm sorry to say this, but we just cannot reply to such subjective questions in this space—it needs a proper article to explain careers in networking and its scope and future. But we do plan to explore this in our November issue. And as far as answering via e-mail, we hope you understand that it is just not feasible